



Individual Instructor Report Spring 2026 Version A for STA 235 - DATA SCI FOR BUSINESS APPLCTNS (05820) (Henrique Bolfarine)

Project Title: **Course Evaluations Spring 2026**

Courses Audience: **58**

Responses Received: **55**

Response Ratio: **94.8 %**

Report Comments

Guide to the Interpretation of Course Evaluations at UT Austin

The goal of course evaluation process at UT Austin is to drive teaching excellence and to support continuous improvement in teaching and learning experiences. Course evaluations provide snapshots of student perspectives on their course-level learning experiences. Most experts on teaching evaluation advise that no individual method gives the complete picture of an instructor's teaching effectiveness, multiple and diverse measures, on multiple occasions, are advised to give a full picture of the teaching effectiveness of a particular instructor. Moreover, other factors, such as size of class, level of the class, and content of the course, can cause small variations in the ratings. Therefore, student perspectives for a particular instructor or course should be interpreted as a snapshot, and not as providing complete information on the teaching effectiveness of that instructor. For additional details, including the scales and how the Mean scores are calculated, please review the Report Guide at the end of this document or, [UT Austin's Viewing Course Evaluation Results webpage](#).

Creation Date: **Monday, July 6, 2026**

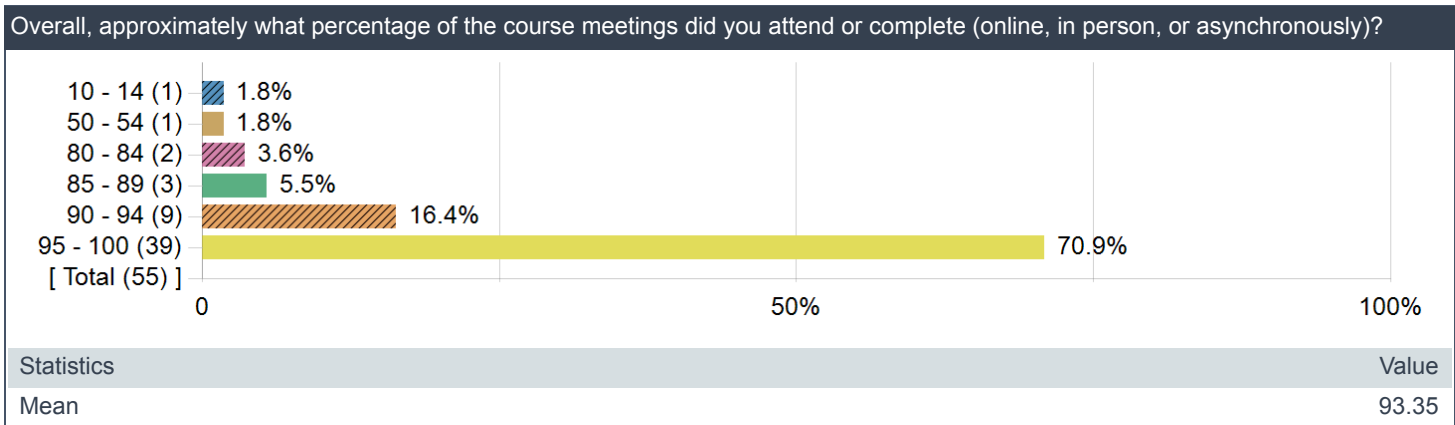
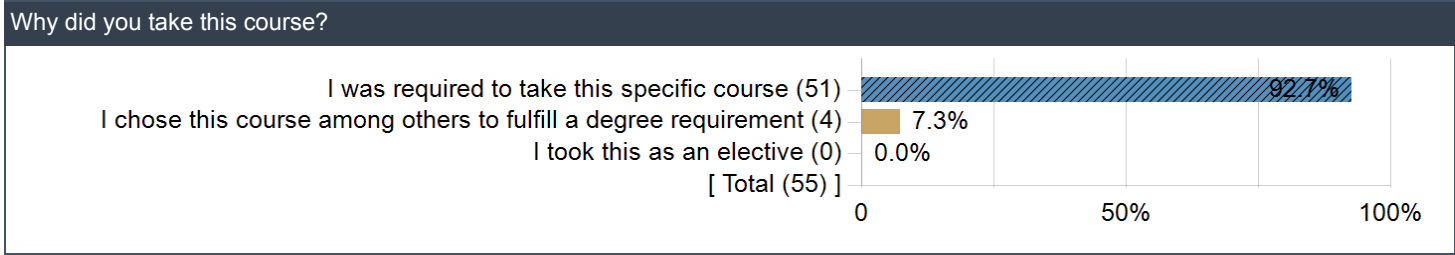
Core Questions

	Strongly Agree	Agree	Neutral	Disagree	Strongly Disagree	Responded	Mean
During this course, I gained a deeper understanding of the subject matter.	30.9%	50.9%	16.4%	0.0%	1.8%	55	4.09
The course was well organized.	43.6%	40.0%	10.9%	3.6%	1.8%	55	4.20
The instructor clearly explained the course objectives and expectations.	54.5%	38.2%	7.3%	0.0%	0.0%	55	4.47
The instructor fostered an inclusive learning environment.	67.3%	25.5%	7.3%	0.0%	0.0%	55	4.60
The instructor effectively explained the concepts and subject matter in this course.	58.2%	27.3%	12.7%	0.0%	1.8%	55	4.40
The instructional techniques kept me engaged in learning.	45.5%	30.9%	14.5%	5.5%	3.6%	55	4.09
The instructor checked for student understanding of the concepts presented in the course.	50.9%	34.5%	10.9%	1.8%	1.8%	55	4.31

Overall Questions

	Excellent	Very Good	Satisfactory	Unsatisfactory	Very Unsatisfactory	Responded	Mean
Overall, this instructor was	43.6%	40.0%	14.5%	1.8%	0.0%	55	4.25
Overall, this course was	27.3%	36.4%	32.7%	3.6%	0.0%	55	3.87

Other Course Questions





Comment Questions

Identify aspects of the course that were the most effective in helping your learning.

Comments
Professor Bolfarine provided lots of resources that we could turn to to study. That was the most helpful.
– the clear explanations of the work we were doing – a lot of provided materials for self study online
Doing in class problems and being able to follow along in R–studio
Very clear with announcements.
Professor Bolfarine proved to be the most effective factor in my learning. He is professional, knowledgeable, fair, cares about his student's growth and very passionate about the subject matter. There is easily a world where this subject could be taught in a mundane way. But the professor brought great real world examples, kept classes engaging, encouraged class participation and his passion for the material made the class highly enjoyable and manageable. He was also available to answer questions and ensured the information was well understood. As someone who went multiple times to his office hours, he would deep dive into my questions and provide further insight to the material. He hosted labs that corresponded to each class every week, which further strengthened my understanding of the material.
The homework helped me out a ton
I liked that he spent less time lecturing and walked through examples in R in class, and used those examples to explain the concepts.
I liked how my professor did not just read off the slides, but he explained things thoroughly, and he would ask us questions to keep us engaged.
He was great and very understanding.
Prof is a great guy and does his best to make a hard subject understandable
Homeworks forced me to learn content pretty well
I enjoyed how he applied the learning objectives to real world problems to help us understand better.
The quizzes and homework really helped prepare for the exams
Professor's teaching style
Explained concepts well. Was overall a good teacher.
It was most helpful to do walkthroughs during class with RStudio, allowing us to learn the material clearly and see how it was going to be applied on the exams and homework assignments.
I enjoyed the lectures and the homeworks that gave you multiple tries.
The professor is very kind and accommodating. He is very willing to work with the students to ensure they are successful.
The homeworks were helpful.
I enjoyed the quiz format
Walking through examples
He was always willing to schedule office hours, highly accessible, explained content very clearly, and even provided an additional lecture video for each unit working through a different example problme.
he posted the s;ides and sripts, great for further review
The lectures are really well put. slides are easy to read and take notes.
The most helpful for my learning was the R studio practice we did in class.
How he teaches in class is helpful because he walks through examples as we take notes.
The homeworks were really helpful to prepare for the quizzes
I liked his use of r studio to show how to code and keep up with the class
agree
It was helpful when Professor Bolfarine typed the code in class and explained the topic, connecting it to the code.
Good practice materials
He was easy to set up office hours with.
Unnecessary class.
Having check in quizzes and the homework were very helpful .
The Instapolls.
Professor cared about helping students and offered many resources
Studying for the test and his lectures, as well as homework.
I think the homework was the most effective for my learning.

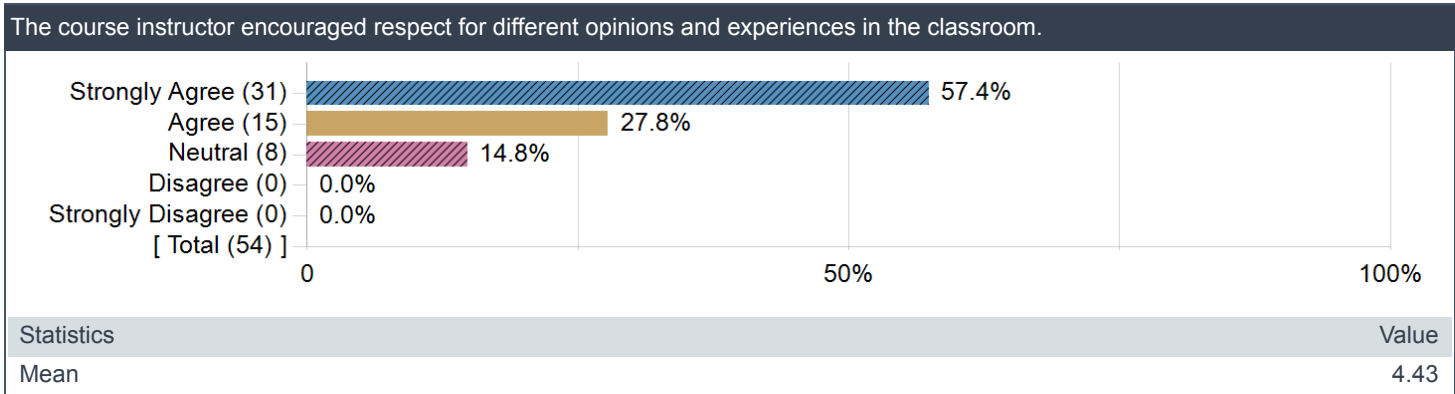
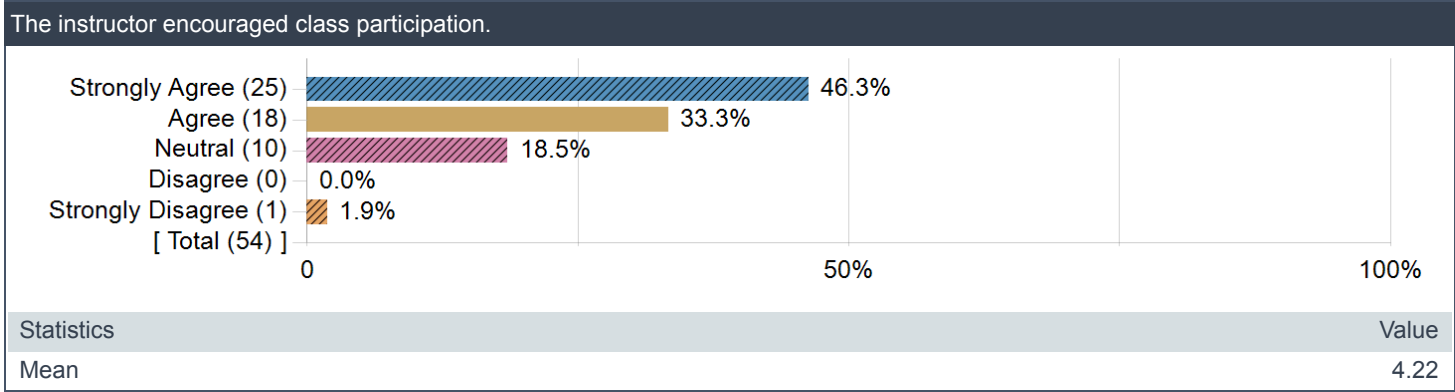
Comments
Lectures
Lectures
Going through specific examples that highlighted learning objectives from the class
Examples in class
N/A
The most effective parts of the course were the homeworks and the practice exams.

Identify the aspect of the course that you found most challenging, why you found it was challenging, and suggest one thing that could be done to help future students meet that challenge more effectively.

Comments
The exams were often really long. Lockdown browser caused a lot of issues with my computer and was difficult to use when taking exams/quizzes.
I think the course itself is not that useful for me and that R is not a language worth prioritizing. It would be much better if we did something like python for excel that would be used in business and finance.
The long lectures, a lot of rambling. Could be more effective.
The subject material was very difficult due to its nuanced nature, but the way it was structured, the additional resources (e.g., labs, in-class examples, review sessions), and the professor's welcoming and passionate attitude addressed the issues.
Though I liked that we didn't have just lectures and slides and more examples, I wish we maybe did a review at the end of class to reiterate the concepts we had learned through the examples.
I found that the practice exam material and in-class quizzes were a lot easier than the actual exam. I would like the material to feel similar in terms of difficulty level.
So many people cheat and don't get caught so the class is super unfair. Content is kind of useless and the kids that didnt take STA 301 specifically (got an exemption) are lost.
Exams were scary
Sometimes we didn't cover all the content in class but it would still appear on homework and some of the in class quizzes felt much more advanced than what we had learned during the previous class
The course itself is challenging. stay on top of assignments
Class would often start a little early and end a little late. As someone who has classes both before and after class, this was particularly stressful.
I found it challenging to follow the Perusall readings at time. It was difficult to read through the content, engage with it as intended, and learn from it. In the future, it could be better to make it more interactive by possibly integrating it into the general homework assignments.
By far the most challenging were the in class quizzes.
The graded in class quizzes were challenging and had a big effect on our grade.
I thought the midterm was most challenging. In the future, I think lectures could better cover the specifics of what is on the test.
Some topics were too complex for only one lecture.
The most challenging aspect was the quizzes because a lot of the time it is our first time seeing a question framed in that way. I don't really think this is a teaching error, it has more to do with the rigor of this class. However, I do think Bolfarine does a great job at preparing us for these. One thing I would suggest if maybe making the homeworks similar to things we are going to see on the quizzes and exams.
he should make his own tests bc sometimes the ehad prof be chanigng stuff and now everyone else is foprccd to scramble and change their studying
I found the topic of statistics uninterested, but that just me. I still learned a lot despite not being interest in the topic
The most challenging parts of the course were the quizzes as the questions were quite different from what we practiced in class the week before.
Most challenging is definitely the exams, and providing practice exams that cover what material is going to be on them is helpful.
I think the textbook discussion posts were not very useful, just busy work.
I found his lectures and accent challenging at times
good
Sometimes he wasn't able to get all the topic information in during class, and the online class was not as descriptive.
lectures were too long and boring
The lectures were wayyy too long. I feel like he went over time every single class and it felt as though all we did was copy his code rather than retaining information.
The teacher was not a good teacher
The course over all is difficult since most arent used to coding.
Keeping up with the in-class R Scripts.
Exams, more accurate practice exams
I mean it is a challenging class but Professor Bolfarine could not be more helpful or kind. I couldn't recommend him more!

Comments
I found having a quiz every week very challenging, especially since we would only talk it about it once. I suggest either having less quizzes or to have the grade distribution between them to be lower because it's really easy to fall behind in this class.
Exams
Exams were pretty challenging.
I found the quizzes quite challenging because I didn't understand what to actually expect.
I think having the previous final as a graded assignment is a little harsh. It would be more helpful if we could see the results and answers to the quizzes earlier because sometimes it took multiple weeks for it to be released.
N/A
The most challenging part of the class was by far were the in-class quizzes that we took every week. I found this as a bad way to check student comprehension because most students cheated on them anyways.

College, School, or Unit Questions



Report Guide

Guide to the Interpretation of Course Evaluations at UT Austin

The goal of course evaluation process at UT Austin is to drive teaching excellence and to support continuous improvement in teaching and learning experiences. The two sets of scales used for core evaluation questions and the associated weights are:

Strongly Agree (5)
Agree (4)
Neutral (3)
Disagree (2)
Strongly Disagree (1)

Excellent (5)
Very Good (4)
Satisfactory (3)
Unsatisfactory (2)
Very Unsatisfactory (1)

The Mean is calculated by adding all of the weights for a single question and dividing by the number of respondents. The course workload question is not averaged.

The number of students (e.g. respondents) marking each option is reported for each of the items. These frequency distributions provide information about the level of student ratings and the spread and shape of the class distribution of responses. The distributions thus provide a picture of student perception of a course.

Course evaluations provide snapshots of student perspectives on their course-level learning experiences. Most experts on teaching evaluation advise that no individual method gives the complete picture of an instructor's teaching effectiveness; multiple and diverse measures, on multiple occasions, are advised to give a full picture of the teaching effectiveness of a particular instructor. Moreover, other factors, such as size of class, level of the class, and content of the course, can cause small variations in the ratings. Therefore, student perspectives for a particular instructor or course should be interpreted as a snapshot, and not as providing complete information on the teaching effectiveness of that instructor.